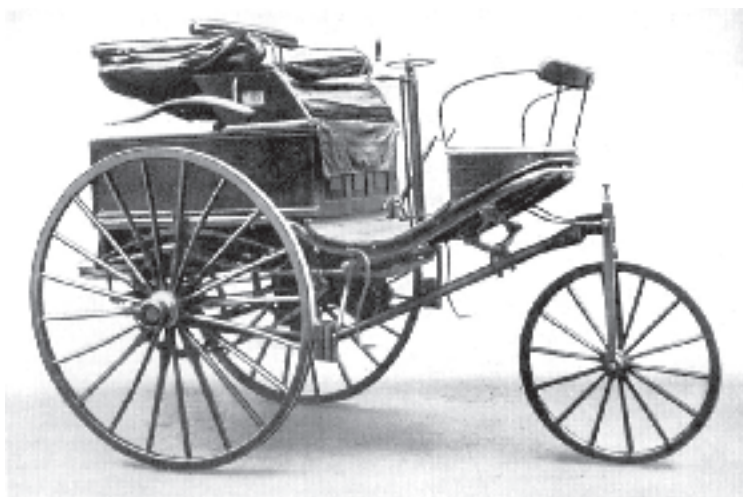


Automobiles

How could we have a list of mankind's greatest inventions and not have the ubiquitous automobile! Much like electricity and radio transmission, the history of the automobile is one that's debatable. You can't really pin down the invention on one person. The first problem in doing so is the very definition of the automobile. If it's simply a self-propelled vehicle then its inventor would have to be Nicolas-Joseph Cugnot who built a steam-powered tricycle in 1769. If we're talking about electric-powered carriages then it would have to be Robert Anderson from Scotland (1839) or French inventor Gustave Trouvé who demonstrated yet another three-wheeled



vehicle in 1881. But most people acknowledge Karl Benz as the inventor of the modern automobile. His invention ran on an internal combustion engine (which he designed and won a patent for). Incidentally the world's first long distance driver was a woman. Bertha Benz, Karl's wife undertook the 106km journey in 1888 to prove the "road-worthiness of her husband's invention". Atta girl!

Batteries

We seem to take batteries for granted these days and barely give them a second thought. This popular electrical device powers a multitude of technologies from laptops to cars and phones to cameras. Since the invention